

Pilot Hard Stop Criteria & Circuit Breakers

Document Reference: CAW-PILOT-STOP-2026-01
System: Case Ace v2.0 Client Consultation Recording & Note Drafting System
Organisation: Citizens Advice Wandsworth (CAW)
Status: Formally Approved Prior to Pilot Commencement
Effective Date: 2026-09-02
Classification: Official-Sensitive / Governance

1. Principle of Pre-Defined Stop Criteria

[!CAUTION]
Mandatory Governance Pre-Condition:
Under ISO/IEC 42001:2023 and CAW Trustee Governance, Pilot Hard Stop Criteria must be formally established and approved prior to launching any live pilot deployment.
If any of the following pre-defined thresholds is triggered, the pilot is immediately halted across all participating advisers and bureaux. The decision to halt is non-discretionary and binding on all operational managers.

2. Definitive Pilot Circuit Breaker Matrix

PRE-DEFINED PILOT HARD STOP CRITERIA		
Trigger Category	Specific Hard Stop Condition	Action Level
1. Data Protection	Any confirmed transmission of unredacted client PII (name, NINO, DOB, address) to cloud endpoints (GCP).	**IMMEDIATE**
2. Legal / Advice	Any uncorrected material hallucination (e.g. invalid statutory advice or missed court deadline) saved to CRM.	**IMMEDIATE**
3. Client Rights	More than 1 formal client complaint regarding consent coercion or recorded dialogue without clear opt-in.	**IMMEDIATE**
4. Technical Failure	\$\ge 3\$ consecutive consultation crashes resulting in adviser workflow disruption or data loss.	**IMMEDIATE**
5. Equality / EqIA	Systemic ASR failure rate (Word Error Rate \$> 25\%\$) resulting in service disparity for non-native / disabled.	**TARGETED**
6. Supervisory QA	Overall AQS Level 3 pass rate drops below \$80.0\%\$ in any single supervisory evaluation week.	**TEMPORARY**
		PAUSE

3. Detailed Circuit Breaker Definitions & Rationales

Stop Criterion 1: Confirmed Unredacted PII Egress (Zero-Tolerance)

Threshold: Exactly 1 confirmed occurrence of direct personal identifiers bypassing local tokenisation and acoustic muting and reaching Google Cloud Speech-to-Text or Vertex AI.
Rationale: Direct violation of Core Invariant Constraint C5 (Surrogate Tokenisation) and UK GDPR Data Minimisation.
Immediate Protocol:
Revoke all active cloud API keys and bearer tokens.
All 15 advisers instructed to halt Case Ace immediately.
DPO initiates Article 33 breach notification triage within 1 hour.

Stop Criterion 2: Uncorrected Material Statutory Error in Casebook

Threshold: Exactly 1 confirmed instance where an AI-generated draft note contained an inverted legal fact (e.g. stating a Section 21 notice was valid when invalid) or missed a statutory limitation deadline, which was saved to Casebook and given to a client.
Rationale: Directly prejudices client legal rights and advice safety.
Immediate Protocol:
Supervising Caseworker urgently contacts client to issue a corrected advice letter.
Pilot paused pending root-cause investigation into adviser review gate bypass.

Stop Criterion 3: Client Consent Grievance

Threshold: ≥ 2 formal client complaints or documented objections regarding perceived pressure to record consultations.

Rationale: Compromises trust in Citizens Advice Wandsworth and violates UK GDPR freely given consent standards.

Immediate Protocol:

In-person recording suspended across all bureaux.

Consent script training and delivery audited by EDI Lead.

Stop Criterion 4: Severe Equality / ASR Disparity

Threshold: Transcription Word Error Rate exceeding 25% or failure of entity detection on ≥ 3 consultations with clients with protected speech characteristics (dysarthria, heavy accents, interpreter sessions).

Rationale: Violates Section 149 of the Equality Act 2010 (Public Sector Equality Duty).

Immediate Protocol:

Case Ace usage paused for affected cohort.

Review of acoustic models and prompt parameters with Lead EDI Caseworker.

4. Emergency Pilot Halting Procedure (Step-by-Step)

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sequenceDiagram
    participant Detector as Detector as Adviser / Supervisor / DPO
    participant Ops as Ops as Head of Operations
    participant Pilot as 15 Pilot Advisers
    participant Board as Board of Trustees

    Detector->>Ops: Triggers Emergency Stop Notification
    Ops->>Ops: Verifies Condition against Stop Matrix
    Ops->>Pilot: Issues Broadcast "EMERGENCY PILOT HALT - REVERT TO MANUAL"
    Pilot->>Pilot: Close Case Ace; Continue 100% via Standard Manual Notes
    Ops->>Board: Submits Emergency Incident Report (< 24 Hours)
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Broadcast Notification: The Head of Operations broadcasts an urgent SMS and Teams message: "CASE ACE PILOT HALT: All advisers must close Case Ace immediately and revert 100% to manual Casebook note taking."

Access Revocation: DevOps team disables production DNS endpoint and invalidates JWT signing secrets.

Casework Continuity: Consultations proceed without interruption using standard paper/Casebook procedures.

Investigation Report: A formal report detailing root cause, containment, and remedial options is submitted to the Board within 3 working days.